



IMWIRSA

International Maritime Welfare Innovation Research and Support Association

Join the International Network Supporting Seafarers

Global Maritime Welfare Platform — a partnership proposal for seafarers' centres, missions and welfare organisations.

Tallinn

Hamburg

Istanbul

Poti

Constanța

PILOT PORTS · 2026–2028

The Problem We're Solving Together

A seafarer arrives in an unfamiliar port for 8–12 hours, with no single source of information about where to go, what's open, or whether it's safe ashore. Too often, they stay on board.



Little Time

Average port stay: 12–24 hours. There's no time to search for answers.



Scattered Data

Facebook, forums, word of mouth — outdated and unreliable.



Rising Isolation

Depression and loneliness among seafarers exceed the global average.



No Shared Network

Seafarers' centres operate in isolation, without a common platform.

Our Solution: Digital Infrastructure for a Seafarer's Social Life Ashore



Living Port Card

Always-current information for every port worldwide: transport, seafarers' centre, SIM cards, safety, medical.



Port Welfare Manager

A person from the local seafarers' centre updates data via a Telegram bot — a live, trusted source.



Volunteer Support Line

Live chat with a trained volunteer for crisis situations. Anonymous. 24/7 across time zones.

Our Core Principle

Not Replace — Unite and Strengthen

YOUR ORGANISATION KEEPS

- ✓ Your name and history
- ✓ Full independence
- ✓ Your charter and governance
- ✓ Your funding sources
- ✓ Unique identity

AND ALSO GAINS

- ✓ International visibility
- ✓ More visitors
- ✓ Peer knowledge exchange
- ✓ Free digital tools
- ✓ New partnerships

How It Works: The Port Welfare Manager Role

1

You appoint a coordinator

A staff member or volunteer becomes the Port Welfare Manager.

2

Updates via Telegram

Simple bot updates — no new systems to learn.

3

Port card stays current

Seafarers worldwide see live hours, services, contacts.

4

You see the analytics

IMWIRSA shares monthly reports on views and needs.

A coordinator spends roughly 15–20 minutes a week updating data — a minimal workload.

Port Welfare Manager

The project's ambassador in your port

WHO IS A PWM?

- Staff member or volunteer of a seafarers' centre
- Officially accredited by IMWIRSA
- Main platform contact in the port
- Guardian of data accuracy
- First point of contact for seafarers via the platform

RESPONSIBILITIES · 15–20 MIN / WEEK

- Updates the port card via the Telegram bot
- Responds to reports of outdated information
- Welcomes seafarers who reference the platform
- Joins international IMWIRSA network meetings
- Receives monthly analytics for their port

Port Welfare Manager Recognition Options

IMWIRSA offers a flexible model — the organisation and PWM choose what fits.

Option A

Status & Recognition

For volunteers

- Official IMWIRSA PWM certificate
- Listed in the international partner registry
- Named page on the platform site
- Reference letter from IMWIRSA
- Access to the private PWM community

Option B

Financial Support

Where budget allows

- Monthly stipend: €50–150
- Based on port size and activity
- Connectivity costs covered
- Meeting expenses covered
- Annual "Best PWM" award

Option C

Organisational Growth

For seafarers' centres

- Free promotion on the platform
- International partnerships and projects
- Access to IMWIRSA grant programmes
- Staff and volunteer training
- Priority access to new features

Five Pilot Ports — Phase 1 (2026–2028)



Tallinn

Estonia

HQ · Live Pilot

IMWIRSA headquarters. First live testing ground for the model, with a confirmed seafarers' centre partnership.



Hamburg

Germany

Onboarding

One of Europe's largest ports, with an established seafarers' welfare infrastructure.



Istanbul

Türkiye

Onboarding

Strategic crossroads of Europe and Asia — high traffic from the Black Sea and Mediterranean.



Poti

Georgia

Onboarding

A key Black Sea gateway port, expanding the network's reach into the Caucasus region.



Constanța

Romania

Onboarding

The largest port on the Black Sea, serving a broad, multilingual crew population.

Project Roadmap

WE ARE HERE

2026–2028

Stage 1 · Foundation

- 5 pilot ports
- PWA platform (MVP)
- Coordinator Telegram bot
- Volunteer support line
- First 500 users

2029–2032

Stage 2 · Expansion

- 50+ ports in the network
- Family support for seafarers
- Online telemedicine
- International conference
- 10,000 users

2033–2040

Stage 3 · Maturity

- 100+ partners
- Fleet integration
- Preventive wellbeing programmes
- 21st-century welfare standard
- A truly global network

What Your Seafarers' Centre Gains



International Visibility

Seafarers anywhere find your centre through the platform before arriving in port.



More Visitors

Better accessibility of information increases real foot traffic.



Best-Practice Exchange

Access to the experience of 100+ welfare organisations worldwide.



Digital Tools

Free access to the platform, analytics, coordinator bot and new services.



Partner Network

Connections with ports, unions, shipping companies and NGOs.



Status & Influence

A voice in shaping international welfare standards.

How We Measure Success

Targets after 6 months of the pilot

500+

unique users

30%

return in their next port

5 / 5

coordinators active

4.0+

average user rating

50+

volunteer chat contacts

≤ 30 min

volunteer response time

Conditions of Joining the Pilot

× NOT REQUIRED

- Mandatory financial contributions
- Restructuring your organisation
- Changes to your charter or governance
- Exclusivity — you may work with other networks
- New software or hardware
- Special coordinator training

✓ WHAT'S NEEDED

- One Port Welfare Manager from your centre
- 15–20 minutes a week to update data
- Telegram on the coordinator's phone
- A 30-minute introductory call, online
- Willingness to collaborate and grow

Participation is entirely voluntary. You may leave the project at any time, with no consequences.

Next Steps

1

Reply or call

Reach out to IMWIRSA any way that's convenient. We respond within 24 hours.

Now

2

Introductory meeting

A 30–45 minute online call — presentation, questions, format discussion.

Within 2 weeks

3

Your centre's profile

Complete your seafarers' centre profile for the international registry.

Weeks 3–4

4

Pilot begins

Platform access, PWM appointed, work begins in your port.

Summer 2026



Ready to Talk Partnership?

Write to us today — the first meeting is online, 30 minutes.

 imwirsa.org

 info@imwirsa.org

 Tallinn, Estonia (HQ)